

Doctoral Coursework Assignments & Milestones

This document outlines the practitioner-oriented assessment framework and deliverables required for each doctoral module within the Central Global University DBA curriculum.

RBL810

Research Methodology: Quantitative & Qualitative Analyses

Assignment: Mixed-Methods Research Proposal & Data Analysis Strategy

TASK OVERVIEW:

Develop a comprehensive formal research proposal focusing on a specific complex, structural, or operational challenge within a modern enterprise ecosystem. Candidates must architect both an empirical quantitative approach (e.g., structural equation modeling or multi-variable regression analysis using robust survey instruments) and an inductive qualitative approach (e.g., thematic analysis derived from semi-structured executive or stakeholder interviews) to address the issue.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLES:

- **Section 1: Critical Problem Formulation** — Definitive statement of the problem, operational hypotheses, and overarching research questions.
- **Section 2: Research Instrumentation** — Comprehensive sampling strategies, survey scale validations, and formal interview protocols.
- **Section 3: Analytical Triangulation Strategy** — A structured execution roadmap detailing exactly how the qualitative and quantitative datasets will be integrated to validate findings.

Assignment: Critical Systematic Literature Review & Theoretical Framework**TASK OVERVIEW:**

Conduct a highly rigorous, systematic review of at least 30 peer-reviewed, high-impact foundational and contemporary journal articles published within the last five years concerning macro-level corporate strategy or contemporary organizational behavior.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLES:

- **Synthesized Literature Matrix** — An exhaustive conceptual mapping indexing methodologies, precise variables, findings, and identified limitations of the selected literature.
- **Conceptual Framework Construction** — A highly technical visual and narrative synthesis that exposes and isolates an unaddressed empirical research gap.
- **Theoretical Justification** — Definitive theoretical alignment mapping established paradigms (e.g., Resource-Based View, Dynamic Capabilities, or Stakeholder Theory) onto the study's new conceptual model.

Assignment: Applied Pilot Study & Industry Specialization Paper**TASK OVERVIEW:**

Narrow focus into the candidate's elected specialization track (e.g., Strategic Management, Finance, Governance, or Marketing). Candidates will perform an isolated pilot study or an advanced comparative industry case study exploring how modern market disruptions affect their narrow field of inquiry.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLES:

- **Specialization Review** — A highly localized analysis evaluating specific sector risks, policy dynamics, or operational pain points.
- **Pilot Execution Report** — Initial fieldwork summaries utilizing a limited sample size (3–5 expert interviews or a restricted data set) to robustly test the reliability and validity of the proposed research instruments.
- **Instrument Refinement Strategy** — Methodological adjustments documenting modifications made to the ultimate research design based on pilot friction points.

Assignment: The Doctoral Dissertation (Progressive Milestones)**TASK OVERVIEW:**

This phase constitutes the core execution, data gathering, and drafting of the primary independent practitioner-oriented research project. Evaluation is managed through a sequence of critical formal milestones monitored directly by the doctoral supervisor.

REQUIRED MILESTONES:

- **Milestone 1: Institutional Review Board (IRB)** — Final ethics clearance, risk mitigation strategies, and formal research authorization approvals.
- **Milestone 2: Fieldwork & Raw Dataset Submission** — Complete aggregation of field data, interview transcripts, and structured database indexes.
- **Milestone 3: Complete Dissertation Draft** — Submission of the standard five-chapter manuscript containing Introduction, Literature Synthesis, Methodological Framework, Findings & Data Analyses, and Actionable Practical Recommendations for Corporate Practitioners.

Assignment: Oral Defense Presentation & Academic Defense Dossier**TASK OVERVIEW:**

Prepare, deliver, and defend the final completed dissertation research before an officially appointed Academic and Professional Examination Board. Candidates must comprehensively justify their empirical models, research ethics, conclusions, and contributions to original executive practice under cross-examination.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLES:

- **Defense Presentation Slide Deck** — A concise, highly polished 20-minute visual presentation demonstrating the core mechanics, data justifications, and industrial contributions of the thesis.
- **Executive Briefing Dossier** — A 3-page summary whitepaper delineating direct practitioner solutions, strategic policy impacts, and executive takeaways, distributed to board members prior to the session.